



Barsham became the star in the quarterfinal through three crucial saves in the penalty shootout.

Two of the biggest shocks of this Asian Cup were the exits of Japan, the highest-ranked and the most successful side in the tournament, and South Korea, led by Tottenham Hotspur's captain Son.

Japan was first humbled by Iraq in the group stage and then, Alireza Jahanbakhsh's stoppage-time penalty showed Hajime Moriyasu's side the door in the quarterfinals.

South Korea, on the other hand, almost emulated 'Fergie Time', pulling off an equaliser or even a winner on the verge of full-time to snatch success from the jaws of defeat multiple times.

The approach, deemed as 'Zombie Ball' by the Korean press, saw Son score the winner against Australia in the quarterfinal but Jordan saw it out in their battle for the summit clash.

The Asian Cup's theme song, *Hadaf*, revolves around what exactly

Night of heroes: Yazan Al-Naimat scored the only goal for Jordan in the final. **Right:** Nizar Al-Rashdan of Jordan and Jassem Gaber of Qatar battle for possession in the final.

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should a goal ideally be. After nearly a month of the contest, it ended with the answers — joy, empathy and patience, all that constitutes not just the beautiful game but also life. And that's where the tournament was truly successful.

